MOCK TEST 16

# 📖 READING

5 parts · 35 questions

⏱ 60 minutes

*Vaqt: 60 daqiqa. Javoblarni javoblar varaqasiga o'tkazishni unutmang.*

## PART 1

Questions 1–7

**Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.**

### AUSTRALIA

Australia was the last great landmass to be discovered by the Europeans. The continent they eventually **Q1**_____ had already been inhabited for tens of thousands of years.

Australia is an island **Q2**_____ whose landscape — much of bleak and inhospitable is the result of gradual changes wrought over millions of **Q3**_____.

Although there is still seismic activity in the eastern highland area, **Q4**_____ is one of the most stable land masses, and for about 100 million years has been free of the forces that have given rise to huge mountain ranges elsewhere.

From the east coast a narrow, fertile strip merges into the greatly eroded Great Dividing Range, that is almost continent long.

The mountains are merely reminders of the mighty range, that once stood here. Only in the section straddling the New South Wales border with Victoria and in Tasmania, are they high enough to have winter snow.

West of the **Q5**_____ of the country becomes increasingly flat and dry. The endless flatness is broken only by salt lakes, occasional mysterious protuberances and some **Q6** _____ whose beauty reminds of the MacDonald Ranges. In places the scant vegetation is sufficient to allow some grazing. However, much of the Australian outback is a barren land of harsh stone deserts and dry lakes.

The extreme north of Australia, the Top End, is a tropical area within the monsoon belt. Although its annual rainfall looks adequate on paper, it comes in more or less one short, sharp burst. This has prevented the Top End from becoming seriously productive **Q7**_____.

## PART 2

Questions 8–12

**The people below in 8-12 all want to do a course. Look at the descriptions of eight courses (A-H). Decide which course would be most suitable for each person.**

**8**
**Martina**
Martina is an accomplished photographer looking for an enjoyable course where she can improve her skills. She loves taking pictures outdoors and is only free at weekends.

**9**
**Manuel**
Manuel has painted for ten years and wants to learn about the work of famous painters from the past. He is looking for a day-time course that will help him improve his painting skills.

**10**
**Maria**
Maria is 32, and she would like to do computer studies in Manchester. She wants to do a part-time course that includes theory and practical skills. In her spare time, she paints and draws.

**11**
**Claudia**
Claudia would like a course where she can learn the basic concepts of drawing. She works in the morning but is free at weekends. She is most interested in drawing portraits but does not need a qualification.

**12**
**Sally**
Sally is 25. She wants to take up an activity that will give her a lot of contact with other people. She is very talented and likes performing.

A) ITB and computer courses. Full-time courses. This full-time course is designed to help you improve the digital skills you use in everyday life. These skills will allow you to use computers confidently and effectively in both your working and personal life. This course is suitable for those who want to study in the evening.

B) NTB. A Photographic Adventure. This beginner digital photography course is meant to help you master your digital camera. You will finally be able to enter the magical world of photography! Professional photographers will show you how to see the world as a photographer, whether you're just starting or you've been taking photos for years.

C) 3D Studio. Part-time courses. 3D Studio has a fun 34-week photo challenge. All courses are led by a professional photographer who has specific skills to teach you. By learning with 3D Studio, we will take you to the best places and venues in the countryside. The course takes place on Saturdays, 3.30-6.00 p.m.

D) Adam Elliot Studio. Renaissance Painting Workshop. During this workshop, students will be taught the classical methods of oil painting used by Italian and Flemish masters of the late 16th and early 17th centuries. This workshop is suitable for students of all levels of experience. Classes are on Monday and Wednesday from 9-11 a.m.

E) Santa Reparata. Supplementary Art Course. The main aim of this short course is to provide an introduction to one of the most famous periods of Italian Art. The one-week painting course is suitable for absolute beginners. Classes are from 6.30-9.30 p.m. Monday to Friday.

F) The Art Academy. Open Life Class. This is an informative, intensive, and fun weekend course, which teaches essential drawing skills. Through various drawing approaches including life drawing, portraiture, and still life, you will learn to understand texture, line, measurement, and composition.

G) The Open University. Computing and IT. Our Adult courses give you the chance to boost your confidence and develop your work skills. This course will prepare you for progression to further study in computing and software development. Full-time and part-time courses are available.

H) Jennifer Collins Theatre School. Musical theatre courses. This course aims to provide participants with the opportunity to train to the highest standards for a professional career in Dance and Musical Theatre. We offer a chance to meet new friends in a family-like environment.

## PART 3

Questions 13–18

**Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.**

**List of Headings:**

I) Cons of the commuting
II) Thing that students have to go through
III) Commutes have become common in Ireland nowadays
IV) Danger of the overflow
V) Cause of the problems
VI) Pricing data
VII) Regression
VIII) Eyeless choice

**13. Paragraph A** **14. Paragraph B** **15. Paragraph C**
**16. Paragraph D** **17. Paragraph E** **18. Paragraph F**

### THE STUDENTS' PROBLEM

**A.** The college and university accommodation crisis in Ireland has become 'so chronic' that students are being forced to sleep rough, share a bed with strangers – or give up on studying altogether.

**B.** The deputy president of the Union of Students in Ireland, Kevin Donoghue, said the problem has become particularly acute in Dublin. He told the Irish Mirror: "Students are so desperate, they're not just paying through the nose to share rooms – they're paying to share a bed with complete strangers. It reached crisis point last year and it's only getting worse. "We've heard of students sleeping rough; on sofas, floors and in their cars and I have to stress there's no student in the country that hasn't been touched by this crisis. "Commutes – which would once have been considered ridiculous – are now normal, whether that's by bus, train or car and those who drive often end up sleeping in their car if they've an early start the next morning."

**C.** Worry is increasing over the problems facing Ireland's 200,000 students as the number increases over the next 15 years. With 165,000 full-time students in Ireland – and that figure expected to increase to around 200,000 within the next 15 years – fears remain that there aren't enough properties to accommodate current numbers.

**D.** Claims have emerged from the country that some students have been forced to sleep in cars, or out on the streets, because of the enormous increases to rent in the capital. Those who have been lucky enough to find a place to live have had to do so 'blind' by paying for accommodation, months in advance, they haven't even seen just so they will have a roof over their head over the coming year.

**E.** According to the Irish Independent, it's the 'Google effect' which is to blame. As Google and other blue-chip companies open offices in and around Dublin's docklands area, which are 'on the doorstep of the city', international professionals have been flocking to the area which will boast 2,600 more apartments, on 50 acres of undeveloped land, over the next three to 10 years.

**F.** Rent in the area soared by 15 per cent last year and a two-bedroom apartment overlooking the Grand Canal costs €2,100 (£1,500) per month to rent. Another two-bedroom apartment at Hanover Dock costs €2,350 (almost £1,700) with a three-bedroom penthouse – measuring some 136 square metres – sits at €4,500 (£3,200) per month in rent.

## PART 4

Questions 19–28

**Read the following text for questions 19-28.**

### TOP COMPANIES WITH PART-TIME OPENINGS

**1. The Vitamin Shoppe: 1,946 part-time openings.** The Vitamin Shoppe is a New Jersey-based retailer of nutritional supplements. They also operate stores in Canada under the name "VitaPath". The company provides approximately 8,000 different SKU's of supplements through its retail stores and over 20,000 different SKU's of supplements through its online retail websites.

*Employee Review:* "Good growth opportunities and stores opening all over the US all year 'round. Company based out of NJ, so more progressive policies on employment and benefits. Good vacation, health, and dental benefits. Payment is above average. Good policies on customer service interaction as well. Focus on Customer service vs. pushing products."

**2. Chipotle: 1,553 part-time openings.** Chipotle is known for its use of organic meats throughout its more than 1,500 restaurants, which are located in 45 states. Since having been founded in 1993, the chain has since exploded and now counts some 37,000 employees. It is a pioneer in the "fast casual" dining movement.

*Employee Review:* "The people I work with are awesome and the food is good. It pays my bills and makes me laugh. The schedule is super flexible but it's a lot of work. If you're looking for something easy and laid back, keep looking."

**3. Advantage Sales & Marketing: 1,742 part-time openings.** Advantage Sales & Marketing provides outsourced sales, merchandising, and marketing services to consumer goods and food product manufacturers and suppliers. Owning more than 65 offices in the US and Canada, ASM does merchandising for 1,200 clients -- including Johnson & Johnson, Mars, Unilever, Energizer.

*Employee Review:* "Long lasting business, able to adapt to changes in market. Well-thought out schedule, and flexible time off for both vacation and illness."

**4. Universal Protection Service: 1,219 part-time openings.** Universal Protection Service is one of the largest providers of security services in the U.S. They offer an expansive range of security solutions for airports, healthcare facilities, office buildings, and more.

*Employee Review:* "Good pay depending on where you work. Room for advancement based on availability. Better company than any other I have worked for in security."

**5. PSA Healthcare: 1,295 part-time openings.** PSA Healthcare, also known as Pediatric Services of America, provides comprehensive home health services through a branch of office across the United States. The company is headquartered in Atlanta, Ga.

*Employee Review:* "I love working one-on-one with the pediatric patient and their families. You have the time needed to give great compassionate care! Office staff and supervisors are very good with both employees and clients. There is a lot of flexibility with staffing. I never received grief for requesting a day off."

**For questions 19-25, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D.**

**19 Which offer has the most part-time openings?**
A) Chipotle
B) PSA Healthcare
C) The Vitamin Shoppe
D) Advantage Sales & Marketing

**20 Which of these companies operate both in USA and Canada?**
A) The Vitamin Shoppe and Advantage Sales & Marketing
B) PSA Healthcare and Advantage Sales & Marketing
C) Chipotle and PSA Healthcare
D) PSA Healthcare and The Vitamin Shoppe

**21 Review of which company says that it is the best security company he/she worked for?**
A) Chipotle
B) The Vitamin Shoppe
C) Universal Protection Service
D) PSA Healthcare

**22 Which company was founded in 1993?**
A) The Vitamin Shoppe
B) Universal Protection Service
C) PSA Healthcare
D) Chipotle

**23 Main office of which company is situated in Atlanta?**
A) The Vitamin Shoppe
B) PSA Healthcare
C) Chipotle
D) Advantage Sales & Marketing

**24 VitaPath is the other name of which company?**
A) PSA Healthcare
B) Universal Protection Service
C) The Vitamin Shoppe
D) Advantage Sales & Marketing

**25 Which review doesn't mention a comfortable timetable?**
A) Chipotle
B) Advantage Sales & Marketing
C) The Vitamin Shoppe
D) PSA Healthcare

**Do the following statements agree with the information given?**

**26 The Vitamin Shoppe has an above average salary, according to the review.**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

**27 Reviewer of the company Chipotle says that working there is both fun and earns enough money.**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

**28 Advantage Sales & Marketing owns 65 offices all over the world.**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

## PART 5

Questions 29–35

**Read the following text for questions 29-35.**

### WORKPLACE DISMISSALS

***Before the dismissal***

If an employer wants to dismiss an employee, there is a process to be followed. Instances of minor misconduct and poor performance must first be addressed through some preliminary steps.

Firstly, you should be given an improvement note. This will explain the problem, outline any necessary changes and offer some assistance in correcting the situation. Then, if your employer does not think your performance has improved, you may be given a written warning. The last step is called a final written warning which will inform you that you will be dismissed unless there are improvements in performance. If there is no improvement, your employer can begin the dismissal procedure.

The dismissal procedure begins with a letter from the employer setting out the charges made against the employee. The employee will be invited to a meeting to discuss these accusations. If the employee denies the charges, he is given the opportunity to appear at a formal appeal hearing in front of a different manager. After this, a decision is made as to whether the employee will be let go or not.

***Dismissals***

Of the various types of dismissal, a fair dismissal is the best kind if an employer wants an employee out of the workplace. A fair dismissal is legally and contractually strong and it means all the necessary procedures have been correctly followed. In cases where an employee's misconduct has been very serious, however, an employer may not have to follow all of these procedures. If the employer can prove that the employee's behaviour was illegal, dangerous or severely wrong, the

employee can be dismissed immediately: a procedure known as summary dismissal.

Sometimes a dismissal is not considered to have taken place fairly. One of these types is wrongful dismissal and involves a breach of contract by the employer. This could involve dismissing an employee without notice or without following proper disciplinary and dismissal procedures. Another type, unfair dismissal, is when an employee is sacked without good cause.

There is another kind of dismissal, known as constructive dismissal, which is slightly peculiar because the employee is not actually openly dismissed by the employer. In this case the employee is forced into resigning by an employer who tries to make significant changes to the original contract. This could mean an employee might have to work night shifts after originally signing on for day work, or he could be made to work in dangerous conditions.

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the text for each answer.**

If an employee receives a **29** _____, this means he will lose his job if his work does not get better.

If an employee does not accept the reasons for his dismissal, a **30** _____ can be arranged.

**Look at the following descriptions (Questions 31-35) and the list of terms in the box below. Match each description with the correct term A-E.**

**31** **An employee is asked to leave work straight away because he has done something really bad.**

A) Fair dismissal
B) Summary dismissal
C) Unfair dismissal
D) Wrongful dismissal
E) Constructive dismissal

**32** **An employee is pressured to leave his job unless he accepts conditions that are very different from those agreed to in the beginning.**

A) Fair dismissal
B) Summary dismissal
C) Unfair dismissal
D) Wrongful dismissal
E) Constructive dismissal

**33** **An employer gets rid of an employee without keeping to conditions in the contract.**

A) Fair dismissal
B) Summary dismissal
C) Unfair dismissal
D) Wrongful dismissal
E) Constructive dismissal

**34** **The reason for an employee's dismissal is not considered good enough.**

A) Fair dismissal
B) Summary dismissal
C) Unfair dismissal
D) Wrongful dismissal
E) Constructive dismissal

**35** **The reasons for an employee's dismissal are acceptable by law and the terms of the employment contract.**

A) Fair dismissal
B) Summary dismissal
C) Unfair dismissal
D) Wrongful dismissal
E) Constructive dismissal

## MOCK TEST 16

35 answers

1 discovered
2 continent
3 years
4 Australia
5 range
6 mountains
7 area
8 C
9 D
10 G
11 F
12 H
13 II
14 III
15 IV
16 VIII
17 V
18 VI
19 C / The Vitamin Shoppe
20 A / The Vitamin Shoppe and Advantage Sales & Marketing
21 C / Universal Protection Service
22 D / Chipotle
23 B / PSA Healthcare
24 C / The Vitamin Shoppe
25 C / The Vitamin Shoppe
26 True
27 True
28 False
29 final written warning
30 formal appeal hearing
31 B / Summary dismissal
32 E / Constructive dismissal
33 D / Wrongful dismissal
34 C / Unfair dismissal
35 A / Fair dismissal